Specification of the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”

approved by decree no. 2011-1373 of 25 October 2011, amended by decree no. 2014-1069 of 19 September 2014, amended by order of 20 June 2016 published in the JORF of 29 June 2016, amended by order of 12 September 2019 published in the JORF of 25 September 2019, amended by order of 28 May 2021 published in the JORF of 2 June 2021, amended by order of 21 August 2023 published in the JORF of 26 August 2023, amended by order of 18 November 2024 published in the JORF of 21 November 2024, amended by order of 26 May 2025 published in the JORF of 31 May 2025

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, initially recognised by ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945.

This specification is drawn up in accordance with the provisions of ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945 and without prejudice to law no. 72-628 of 5 July 1972.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by a sub-regional, communal or local geographical denomination, according to the provisions defined in points 2° and 3° below.

2° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the following complementary geographical denominations for wines meeting the production conditions set for each of these complementary geographical denominations in the present specification:

- “Bergheim”;
- “Blienschwiller”;
- “Coteaux du Haut-Koenigsbourg”;
- “Côtes de Barr”;
- “Côte de Rouffach”;
- “Klevener de Heiligenstein”;
- “Ottrott”;
- “Rodern”;
- “Saint-Hippolyte”;
- “Scherwiller”;
- “Vallée Noble”;
- “Val Saint Grégoire”;
- “Wolxheim”.

3° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the name of a lieu-dit, for wines meeting the production conditions set for the indication of a lieu-dit in the present specification.

4° – The name of the controlled designation of origin, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, may be supplemented by one of the following customary denominations, provided that the wines come exclusively from the grape varieties that may

be designated under the denomination concerned and according to the production conditions set out in the present specification:

CUSTOMARY DENOMINATION	GRAPE VARIETIES
White wines	
Auxerrois	auxerrois B
Chasselas or Gutedel	chasselas B and chasselas rose Rs
Gewurztraminer	gewurztraminer Rs
Muscat	muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B
Muscat Ottonel	muscat ottonel B
Pinot blanc	auxerrois B, pinot blanc B
Pinot or Klevner	auxerrois B, pinot blanc B, pinot noir N vinified as white, pinot gris G
Pinot gris	pinot gris G
Riesling	riesling B
Sylvaner	sylvaner B
Red wines	
Pinot noir	pinot noir N
Rosé wines (or Clairet or Schillerwein)	
Pinot noir	pinot noir N

5° – The name of the controlled designation of origin, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, may be supplemented by the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles” for wines meeting the production conditions set for these terms in the present specification. These terms must be supplemented by one of the following customary denominations as defined in 4° above: Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris, Riesling.

6° – The name of the controlled designation of origin, except where it is followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, may be supplemented by the customary denomination “Edelzwicker”, exclusively for still white wines meeting the production conditions set for this customary denomination in the present specification.

III. – Colour and types of product

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS, TERMS	TYPE OF PRODUCT AND COLOUR OF THE WINES
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”	Still white, red and rosé wines
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the name of a lieu-dit	Still white and red wines
Complementary geographical denominations: “Bergheim”; “Blienschwiller”; “Coteaux du Haut Koenigsbourg”; “Côtes de Barr”; “Klevener de Heiligenstein”; “Scherwiller”; “Vallée Noble”; “Val Saint Grégoire”; “Wolxheim”	Still white wines
Complementary geographical denominations: “Rodern”; “Saint Hippolyte”; “Ottrott”	Still red wines

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS, TERMS	TYPE OF PRODUCT AND COLOUR OF THE WINES
Complementary geographical denomination “Côte de Rouffach”	Still white and red wines
Terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles”	Still white wines

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The geographical area is as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 3 February 2000. The perimeter of this area, on the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024. The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the INAO website.

a) – For the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by the name of a lieu-dit, the harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes:

- Haut-Rhin department: Ammerschwihr, Beblenheim, Bennwihr, Bergheim, Bergholtz, Bergholtz-Zell, Berrwiller, Buhl, Cernay, Colmar, Eguisheim, Gueberschwihr, Guebwiller, Hartmanswiller, Hattstatt, Herrlisheim, Houssen, Hunawihr, Husseren-les-Châteaux, Ingersheim, Jungholtz, Katzenthal, Kaysersberg Vignoble, Leimbach, Mittelwihr, Niedermorschwihr, Obermorschwihr, Orschwihr, Osenbach, Pfaffenheim, Ribeauvillé, Riquewihr, Rorschwihr, Rodern, Rouffach, Saint-Hippolyte, Soultz, Soultzmatt, Steinbach, Thann, Turckheim, Uffholtz, Vieux-Thann, Voegtlinshoffen, Walbach, Wattwiller, Westhalten, Wettolsheim, Wihr-au-Val, Wintzenheim, Wuenheim, Zellenberg, Zimmerbach.

- Bas-Rhin department: Albé, Andlau, Avolsheim, Balbronn, Barr, Bergbieten, Bernardswiller, Bernardvillé, Bischoffsheim, Blienschwiller, Boersch, Bourgheim, Châtenois, Cleebourg, Dahlenheim, Dambach-la-Ville, Dangolsheim, Dieffenthal, Dorlisheim, Eichhoffen, Epfig, Ergersheim, Flexbourg, Furdenheim, Gertwiller, Gimbrett (associated commune, attached to Berstett), Goxwiller, Heiligenstein, Itterswiller, Kienheim, Kintzheim, Kirchheim, Kuttolsheim, Marlenheim, Mittelbergheim, Molsheim, Mutzig, Nothalten, Nordheim, Oberhoffen-lès-Wissembourg, Obernai, Odratzheim, Orschwiller, Osthoffen, Ottrott, Reichsfeld, Riedseltz, Rosenwiller, Rosheim, Rott, Saint-Nabor, Saint-Pierre, Scharrachbergheim-Irmstett, Scherwiller, Soultz-les-Bains, Steinseltz, Stotzheim, Traenheim, Villé, Wangen, Westhoffen, Wissembourg, Wolxheim, Zellwiller.

b) – For the complementary geographical denominations referred to in point II 2°, the harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out exclusively within the territory of the following communes:

COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATIONS	COMMUNES
“Bergheim”	Bergheim and Ribeauvillé (Haut-Rhin department)
“Blienschwiller”	Blienschwiller (Bas-Rhin department)
“Coteaux du Haut Koenigsbourg”	Chatenois, Kintzheim, Orschwiller (Bas-Rhin department) and Saint Hippolyte (Haut-Rhin department)
“Côtes de Barr”	Barr (Bas-Rhin department)

COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATIONS	**COMMUNES**
“Côte de Rouffach”	Pfaffenheim, Rouffach and Westhalten (Haut-Rhin department)
“Klevener de Heiligenstein”	Bourgheim, Gertwiller, Goxwiller, Heiligenstein and Obernai (Bas-Rhin department)
“Ottrott”	Ottrott and Obernai (Bas-Rhin department)
“Rodern”	Rodern and Saint Hippolyte (Haut-Rhin department)
“Saint Hippolyte”	Saint Hippolyte (Haut-Rhin department), Orschwiller (Bas-Rhin department)
“Scherwiller”	Scherwiller (Bas-Rhin department)
“Val Saint Grégoire”	Turckheim, Zimmerbach, Walbach and Wihr-au-Val (Haut-Rhin department)
“Vallée Noble”	Westhalten and Soultzmatt (Haut-Rhin department)
“Wolxheim”	Wolxheim and Dahlenheim (Bas-Rhin department)

2° – Delimited parcel area

a) – The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 9 and 10 November 1988, 4 and 5 November 1998, 10 and 11 February 1999, 27 and 28 May 1999, 27 and 28 May 2004, 9 March 2005, 9 and 10 November 2005, 13 March 2008, 10 February 2011, 11 September 2014, 30 November 2022 and 25 June 2024.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

b) – For the geographical denomination “Klevener de Heiligenstein”, the wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 6 and 7 November 1996.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

c) – For the complementary geographical denominations defined in 1° b) of point IV, with the exception of the denomination “Klevener de Heiligenstein”, the wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 16 November 2010, 29 June 2012 and 25 June 2024.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

a) – For the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by the name of a lieu-dit, the immediate proximity area defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines is made up of the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2024:

Haut-Rhin department: Gundolsheim, Ostheim.

Bas-Rhin department: Dachstein, Ernolsheim-Bruche, Fessenheim-le-Bas, Petersbach, Seebach, Strasbourg.

Commune included in part: Wingersheim les Quatre Bans, for the territory of the delegated commune of Mittelhausen only.

b) – For the complementary geographical denominations listed in point II 2°, the immediate proximity area is made up of the territory of the communes of the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" listed in point IV 1° a) and of the territory of the communes of the immediate proximity area listed in a) above, excluding, for each complementary geographical denomination, the territory of the commune(s) making up its geographical area as set in point IV 1° b).

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Rules on grape varieties

a) – The wines come from the following varieties:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS, TERMS	**GRAPE VARIETIES**
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"	
Rosé wines	pinot noir N
Rosé wines: varieties of interest for adaptation purposes, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operators concerned of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee	coliris N, nebbiolo N, syrah N
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", whether or not followed by the name of a lieu-dit	
White wines	auxerrois B, chasselas B and chasselas rose Rs, gewurztraminer Rs, muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot blanc B, pinot gris G, pinot noir N, riesling B, sylvaner B, and savagnin rose Rs for the parcels belonging to the delimited parcel area of the geographical denomination "Klevener de Heiligenstein" only
White wines, except for the AOC Alsace followed by the name of a lieu-dit: varieties of interest for adaptation purposes, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operators concerned of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee	voltis B, opalor B, selenor B, souvignier gris G, johanniter B, chenin B, vermentino B
Red wines	pinot noir N
Red wines, except for the AOC Alsace followed by the name of a lieu-dit: varieties of interest for adaptation purposes, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operators concerned of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee	coliris N, nebbiolo N, syrah N

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS, TERMS	**GRAPE VARIETIES**
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by a complementary geographical denomination	
“Bergheim”	gewurztraminer Rs
“Blienschwiller”, “Côtes de Barr”	sylvaner B
“Coteaux du Haut Koenigsbourg”	gewurztraminer Rs and riesling B
“Côte de Rouffach”	gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, riesling B and pinot noir N
“Klevener de Heiligenstein”	savagnin rose Rs
“Ottrott”, “Rodern”, “Saint Hippolyte”	pinot noir N
“Vallée Noble”	gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G and riesling B
“Val Saint Grégoire”	auxerrois B, pinot blanc B and pinot gris G
“Scherwiller”, “Wolxheim”	riesling B
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”	
Customary denomination “Edelzwicker”	from one or more of the varieties listed above for white wines
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit	
Terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles”	gewurztraminer Rs, muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot gris G, riesling B

b) – The communal planting plan approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality will be lodged at the town hall of the communes concerned.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

a) – White wines: the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 5 % of the planting of the holding.

b) – Rosé wines: the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 5 % of the planting of the holding.

c) – Red wines: the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 5 % of the planting of the holding.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

GENERAL PROVISIONS

“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”

The vines have a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. They may not have a spacing between rows greater than 2.50 metres. The vines have a spacing within the row of between 0.75 metre

minimum and 1.50 metres maximum.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit

The vines have a minimum planting density of 4,500 plants per hectare. They may not have a spacing between rows greater than 2 metres. The vines have a spacing within the row of between 0.75 metre minimum and 1.50 metres maximum.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by a complementary geographical denomination

The vines have a minimum planting density of 4,500 plants per hectare. They may not have a spacing between rows greater than 2.20 metres. The vines have a spacing within the row of between 0.75 metre minimum and 1.50 metres maximum.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"

The vines have a minimum planting density of 4,500 plants per hectare. They may not have a spacing between rows greater than 2 metres. The vines have a spacing within the row of between 0.75 metre minimum and 1.50 metres maximum.

PARTICULAR PROVISION

From 25 October 2011, the date of the first approval of the present specification, the grubbing-up of rows within a parcel may not result in a spacing between the widest rows greater than 3 metres.

b) – Pruning rules

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"

The vines are pruned by single or double Guyot pruning with a maximum of 24 free eyes per plant.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by a complementary geographical denomination

The vines are pruned by single or double Guyot pruning with a maximum of 22 free eyes per plant.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"

The vines are pruned by single or double Guyot pruning with a maximum of 20 free eyes per plant.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"

- The foliage is trained on a vertical trellis. The height of trellised foliage may not be less than 0.675 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured between the attachment wire and the upper limit of the foliage after trimming. The distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire may not exceed 0.40 metre.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by a complementary geographical denomination

- The foliage is trained on a vertical trellis. The height of trellised foliage may not be less than 0.675 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured between the attachment wire and the upper limit of the foliage after trimming. The distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire may not exceed 0.30 metre.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"

- The foliage is trained on a vertical trellis. The height of trellised foliage may not be less than 0.675 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured between the attachment wire and the upper limit of the foliage after trimming. The distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire may not exceed 0.30 metre.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set according to the table below:

GRAPE VARIETIES	**AVERAGE MAXIMUM LOAD PER PARCEL (kilograms per hectare)**
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"	
auxerrois B, chasselas B and chasselas rose Rs, pinot blanc B, sylvaner B	14,000
muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B, riesling B	13,000
gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G, savagnin rose Rs	12,000
Other varieties	14,000
pinot noir N	11,500
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by a complementary geographical denomination	
pinot noir N	9,000
Other varieties	12,000
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"	
All varieties	10,000

Where irrigation is authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of irrigated parcels is set at:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, EXCEPT COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATIONS, LIEUX-DITS, "VENDANGES TARDIVES" AND "SÉLECTION DE GRAINS NOBLES"	**AVERAGE MAXIMUM LOAD PER PARCEL (kilograms per hectare)**
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"	
White wines	10,000
Rosé wines	10,000
Red wines	8,000

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils, which constitute a fundamental element of the terroir:

- Headlands wider than one metre are grassed, with the exception of vines that cannot be mechanised, known locally as “Kammerle”.

- Partial or total covering of the soil and of the vines with sheeting is prohibited.

- However, for evaluation purposes, covering of the soil with sheeting is authorised under the following conditions. The material must be permeable, allow gas and water exchanges, and its composition must not include petrochemical polymers. The evaluation is carried out subject to the signature of an agreement between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operator concerned, conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee of 29 and 30 June 2023. In this context, the area of the parcels subject to the evaluation is limited to 5 % of the total area of the holding declared under the AOC.

b) Vine plantings and replantings are carried out with plant material all of whose components are produced in protected zones or have undergone hot-water treatment as defined by the order in force relating to the control of flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

a) Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. Irrigation is prohibited for parcels that have been the subject of a prior declaration of parcel assignment with a view to the potential claim of complementary geographical denominations, lieux-dits and the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles”.

b) Overhead sprinkling of the foliage is prohibited.

c) The application of fertiliser (fertigation) is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness. The date of the start of the harvest is set in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code and of Article 2 of ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945 on the definition of the designations of origin of the wines of Alsace.

b) – Wines liable to benefit from the name of a lieu-dit made from the pinot gris G and pinot noir N varieties come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) – Wines liable to benefit from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” come from grapes harvested by hand.

d) – Containers used for transporting the harvest must be sheltered from bad weather. Washing of the harvest transport containers after each emptying is compulsory.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATIONS, TERMS	**MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)**	**MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not supplemented by the customary denomination Edelzwicker		
White wines	144	9.5 %
Rosé wines	160	10 %
Red wines	177	11 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” supplemented by a customary denomination (white wines)		
Auxerrois	160	10 %
Chasselas or Gutedel	151	9.5 %
Muscat Ottonel, Muscat	151	9.5 %
Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner	160	10 %
Sylvaner	151	9.5 %
Riesling	160	10 %
Gewurztraminer	185	11.5 %
Pinot gris	185	11.5 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not supplemented by a customary denomination		
Pinot noir or Clairet or Schillerwein (rosé wines)	160	10 %
Pinot noir (red wines)	177	11 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the customary denomination		
Chasselas or Gutedel, Auxerrois, Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner, Sylvaner, Riesling, Muscat Ottonel, Muscat (white wines)	168	10.5 %
Gewurztraminer, Pinot gris (white wines)	193	12 %
Pinot noir (red wines)	185	11.5 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by a complementary geographical denomination, with the exception of the complementary geographical denomination “Klevener de Heiligenstein”, supplemented by the customary denomination		
Auxerrois, Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner, Sylvaner, Riesling (white wines)	168	10.5 %
Gewurztraminer, Pinot gris (white wines)	193	12 %
Pinot noir (red wines)	185	11.5 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the complementary geographical denomination “Klevener de Heiligenstein”		
“Klevener de Heiligenstein”	177	11 %

b) – The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines intended for the production of wines liable to benefit from one of the terms “vendanges tardives” or

"sélection de grains nobles" meet the following characteristics:

GRAPE VARIETIES	**"Vendanges tardives": MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (g/l of must)**	**"Vendanges tardives": MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**	**"Sélection de grains nobles": MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (g/l of must)**	**"Sélection de grains nobles": MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
gewurztraminer Rs, pinot gris G	270	16 %	306	18.2 %
muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B, riesling B	244	14.5 %	276	16.4 %

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

a) – The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set, for white wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin "Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", at 80 hectolitres per hectare. The maximum authorised yield per customary denomination is as follows:

CUSTOMARY DENOMINATION	**MAXIMUM AUTHORISED YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
Auxerrois	100
Chasselas or Gutedel	100
Gewurztraminer	80
Muscat	90
Muscat Ottonel	90
Pinot blanc	100
Pinot or Klevner	100
Pinot gris	80
Riesling	90
Sylvaner	100

b) – The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT	**YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"	
Rosé wines	75
Red wines	60
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit	
White wines	68

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT	**YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
Red wines	60
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by a complementary geographical denomination	
White wines	72
Red wines	60
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the term “vendanges tardives”	
White wines	55
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the term “sélection de grains nobles”	
White wines	40

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT	**LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)**
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”	
White wines	96
Rosé wines	90
Red wines	66
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the name of a lieu-dit	
White wines	75
Red wines	66
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by a complementary geographical denomination	
White wines	79
Red wines	66
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the term “vendanges tardives”	
White wines	66
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the term “sélection de grains nobles”	
White wines	48

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by a complementary geographical denomination

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace", whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles"

- parcels of young vines only from the 9th year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 8th year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing

- The installation for receiving and pressing the harvest is sheltered from all kinds of bad weather, as is the press while it is in operation;

- The floor of the reception and pressing premises must be easy to clean (nature of the floor, water point, drainage…);

- Daily washing of the press is compulsory.

b) – Blending of varieties

- For white wines, the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

- For rosé wines, the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

- For red wines, the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

c) – Malolactic fermentation

Malolactic fermentation is completed for red wines. At the packaging stage, red wines have a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

d) – Analytical standards

Wines liable to benefit from the customary denomination "Riesling" have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to:

- 6 grams per litre if the wines have been enriched;

- 9 grams per litre if the total acidity expressed as tartaric acid is less than or equal to 6 grams per litre, or 12 grams per litre if the total acidity expressed as tartaric acid is greater than 6 grams per litre.

This rule does not apply to wines from the riesling B variety liable to benefit from the terms "vendanges tardives" or "sélection de grains nobles", nor to wines liable to benefit from a sub-regional, communal or local geographical denomination.

Rosé wines have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 4 grams per litre. This content may be raised to 5 grams per litre if the total acidity is greater than or equal to 2.7 grams per litre expressed as tartaric acid.

Red wines have, after fermentation, a fermentable sugar content (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 2 grams per litre.

e) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- For the elaboration of rosé wines, the use of oenological charcoal, alone or mixed in preparations, is prohibited;

- For wines liable to benefit from the name of a lieu-dit or a complementary geographical denomination, the increase in the minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume may not exceed 2 % vol.;

- Wines liable to benefit from the terms "vendanges tardives" and "sélection de grains nobles" are not enriched in any way;

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed the following total alcoholic strength by volume:

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATION, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT	**TOTAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"	
White wines	12.5 %
"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" supplemented by a customary denomination (white wines)	
Auxerrois	13 %

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, COLOUR OF THE WINES, CUSTOMARY DENOMINATION, COMPLEMENTARY GEOGRAPHICAL DENOMINATION, LIEU-DIT	**TOTAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME**
Chasselas or Gutedel	12.5 %
Muscat Ottonel or Muscat	12.5 %
Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner	13 %
Sylvaner	12.5 %
Riesling	13 %
Gewurztraminer	14.5 %
Pinot gris	14.5 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not supplemented by a customary denomination	
Pinot noir or Clairet or Schillerwein (rosé wines)	13 %
Pinot noir (red wines)	14 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the customary denomination	
Chasselas or Gutedel, Auxerrois, Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner, Sylvaner, Riesling, Muscat Ottonel or Muscat (white wines)	13.5 %
Gewurztraminer, Pinot gris (white wines)	15 %
Pinot noir (red wines)	14.5 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by a complementary geographical denomination, with the exception of the complementary geographical denomination “Klevener de Heiligenstein”, supplemented by the customary denomination	
Auxerrois, Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner, Sylvaner, Riesling (white wines)	13.5 %
Gewurztraminer, Pinot gris (white wines)	15 %
Pinot noir (red wines)	14.5 %
“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the complementary geographical denomination “Klevener de Heiligenstein”	
“Klevener de Heiligenstein”	14 %

f) – Prohibited equipment

- Continuous presses are prohibited;

- Centrifugal pumps for the transfer of the harvest are prohibited.

– Vinification vat capacity

Every operator has a vinification vat capacity equivalent to at least 1.2 times the volume of the previous harvest.

g) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment are in a good general state of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

Wines liable to benefit from the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles” are aged at least until 1 June of the 2nd year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – Wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” are packaged in bottles of the “Vin du Rhin” type meeting the provisions of European regulations and of decree no. 55.673 of 20 May 1955, the order of 13 May 1959 and the decree of 19 March 1963, or in bottles with the following characteristics:

For 300 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.3 and 5.0
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.4 and 3.1

For 150 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.8 and 5.2
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.1 and 3.1

For 100 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 3.6 and 5.0
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.1 and 3.1

For 75 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 3.8 and 5.1
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.8 and 5.0

For 50 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.3 and 5.1
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.5 and 4.2

For 37.5 cl containers: straight glass body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 4.3 and 5.1
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.5 and 5.2

For containers of less than 37.5 cl: straight body, cylindrical in appearance, topped by a neck with an elongated profile, whose ratios do not exceed:

- Total height / base diameter: between 3.3 and 4.4
- Total height / height of the cylindrical part: between 2.6 and 3.0.

b) – For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of an appropriate, closed and covered place for the storage of packaged wines.

5° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer

- The wines are placed on the market for the consumer in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

- At the end of the ageing period, wines benefiting from the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles” are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 June of the 2nd year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which musts, partially fermented musts and wines may not circulate between authorised warehousekeepers

Musts, partially fermented musts and wines may circulate between authorised warehousekeepers at the earliest on 1 December of the year of harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

Geographical location

A Rhineland vineyard, one of the most northerly in France and in Europe, the Alsace vineyard, established mainly on the eastern face of the Vosges foothills, is located in 119 communes of the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments. Stretching 120 km in length, often for less than 1 km in width, the vineyard extends from a small enclave around Cleebourg in the north, then from Marlenheim level with Strasbourg, down to Thann level with Mulhouse in the south.

A highly diversified landscape

The Alsace vineyard is set on a succession of sub-Vosgian hills, interspersed with deep valleys. This very undulating landscape offers diverse orientations with an often marked relief. The altitude of the plantings lies mostly between 200 m and 400 m.

A highly contrasted climate

The climate is clearly semi-continental: temperature differences are large. Winters are cold (the average temperature in January is 1.9 °C) and summers hot and dry (the average temperature in July is above 20 °C). The sum of effective temperatures (above 10 °C) during the vine’s growing period (1 April – 30 September) reaches 1,253 °C. The grape ripening period is characterised by an alternation of hot days and cool nights.

The Vosges massif acts as a protective screen against oceanic influences, a role amplified by a föhn effect, especially in autumn. This protective screen favours:

- high sunshine (1,800 h/year in Colmar);

- low rainfall: the summits of the Vosges receive annual precipitation of the order of 2,000 mm, whereas over the vineyard as a whole annual precipitation lies between 500 mm and 650 mm;

- excellent autumn and late-season conditions;

- a diversity of mesoclimates linked to the diversity of the landscape, the situations of the valleys and the position of the Vosges summits.

A complex geology

The subsidence of the north–south oriented Rhine Graben created an extensive network of geological faults forming a mosaic of small compartments presenting very varied geo-pedological situations. The vineyard lies in the fracture zone between the sedimentary Rhine plain and the crystalline Vosges massif, where all the layers of ground that had accumulated during the various geological periods have been reworked by erosion, thus offering very varied geo-pedological situations:

- brown soils on schist, granite or sandstone (Vosges substrate), shallow, free-draining and tending to acidity;

- colluvial soils of alluvial fans, and alluvial soils, sandy-gravelly, little developed, free-draining and tending to acidity (edge of the alluvial plain);

- calcareous brown soils or rendzina-type soils of the sub-Vosgian hills, as well as interbedded conglomerates and marls, with a good water regime.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

In turn the southern vineyard of the German Empire, then the northern vineyard of the French Republic, the Alsace vineyard has developed over the centuries the cultivation of very aromatic varieties, thereby forging its own identity. These varieties are chasselas B, sylvaner B, pinot blanc B and auxerrois B, riesling B, muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B, gewurztraminer Rs, savagnin rose Rs, pinot gris G and pinot noir N.

Despite the vicissitudes of history, the professionalism and tenacity of the Alsace wine-growers, together with an excellent viticultural training system for almost a century and a half, have enabled the quality and specificities of Alsace wines to be recognised by the markets. All these efforts to rally around the identity term “Alsace” were rewarded by the recognition of Alsace wines as a designation of origin and the creation of the committee of experts for Alsace wines by the Ordinance of 2 November 1945. The controlled designation of origin “Alsace” was then recognised in 1962. Alsace viticulture has been managed since 1912 by the Association des Viticulteurs d’Alsace, today recognised as the defence and management body.

The “Vin du Rhin”-type flute, described in the decree of 1955, is traditionally used for packaging the still wines of Alsace. The decree of 13 May 1959 reserves the use of this flute for a limited number of designation-of-origin vineyards, including the wines of Alsace. The law of 5 July 1972, passed after the great demonstration by 4,000 wine-growers in Colmar, made bottling of wines of the controlled designation of origin “Vin d’Alsace” or “Alsace” compulsory within the Bas-Rhin and Haut-Rhin departments. This law confirms the wine-growers’ determination to preserve the quality of Alsace wines, and in particular their aromatic character, which suffered from bulk transport over long distances.

The wines come from parcels that have been the subject of a rigorous and precise delimitation, inspired by the historical cores of production. The Alsace vineyard has favoured high trellising of the foliage.

The terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” have been used in their German form in Alsace for more than 2 centuries. At the beginning of the 1970s, the producers of the region wished

to protect the originality of these productions. They requested the codification of their usages, which became effective on 1 March 1984. These terms are reserved for the varieties gewurztraminer Rs, muscat à petits grains B, muscat à petits grains Rs, muscat ottonel B, pinot gris G and riesling B. These wines, made from overripe and fragile grapes, are harvested by hand and must undergo a minimum ageing period of 18 months.

The diversity of soil and climate situations of the sub-Vosgian hills is the basis of the communal and local indications frequently used to identify highly qualitative productions with particular characters derived from their terroir. It is customary to mention on the label the names of geographical units smaller than that of the controlled designation of origin "Alsace", such as those of communes or lieux-dits.

In the Middle Ages and until the phylloxera crisis, the different varieties were also cultivated mixed together. In Alsace, these wines were historically called "zwicker" (blend). They then evolved, with the contribution of the so-called "noble" varieties, into "Edelzwicker" wines, a customary denomination complementary to the controlled designation of origin.

The Alsace wine landscape is characterised by grouped settlements, in often fortified villages surrounded by vines with a highly fragmented parcel structure. This original landscape is the legacy of the history of the many conflicts that have marked the region, and it demonstrates the economic importance of the vine, which has endured over the generations. Today the vineyard has 5,000 holdings of very different sizes, built on the family model, for 15,000 ha in production, forming a true geographical and human continuum. This diversity of structure has enabled the vineyard to occupy all markets. Thanks to a rigorous and active collective professional organisation, the very dynamic marketing of the production is harmoniously shared among the three professional families (independent wine-growers, cooperative cellars and grower-merchants).

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

Still white wines make up the great majority of production. The vineyard also produces red and rosé wines from the single variety pinot noir N.

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by customary denominations because the wines come exclusively from the varieties that may be designated under the denomination concerned.

The wines are characterised by a marked freshness based on a dominant natural tartaric acidity linked to good ripeness of the grapes. They show an intense aromatic expression and good volume, punctuated by a length on the palate often underlined by a slight saturation in carbon dioxide (CO2), expressed locally by the term "spretsig", enhancing the minerality and salinity that stimulate salivation. Recognised for centuries for their ageing potential (vins de garde), during which they improve, their great complexity and aromatic power become richer over time.

Six types can be distinguished:

- Dry, mineral wines with taut, ripe acidity. They are generally linked to the following customary denominations: Chasselas, Sylvaner, Pinot blanc, Pinot or Klevner, Auxerrois, Riesling, Muscat and Muscat Ottonel.

- Fruity wines, more supple and marked by high dry extract. They are generally linked to the customary denominations Gewurztraminer and Pinot gris.

The customary denomination "Edelzwicker" also falls within these two types. The above-mentioned customary denominations do not, however, fall strictly within these two main types, and may also, in various particular situations, find their optimal and original expression within the two types described.

Within this whole, wines benefiting from a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit constitute an original feature. The complementary geographical denominations and the lieux-dits fall within these two types of wine by combining the conditions for the optimal expression of each variety selected.

These two types of wine have a colour ranging, most often, from pale yellow with green highlights to golden yellow.

- Wines benefiting from the term “vendanges tardives” often display very exotic aromas of candied fruit, with a fresh finish.

- Wines benefiting from the term “sélection de grains nobles” are more concentrated, powerful wines, often showing aromas of fruit paste.

These two types of wine show a deep colour intensity ranging up to amber yellow. They are wines of very long keeping. They are of remarkable concentration and great aromatic persistence. These two terms are systematically followed by the customary denominations Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris and Riesling and must bear the indication of the vintage.

- Ambitious, fine, elegant red wines linked to the customary denomination Pinot noir. They show various shades of red of sustained intensity. Certain complementary geographical denominations fall solely within this type of wine, combining the conditions for the optimal expression of pinot noir.

- Fresh, fruity and light red or rosé wines that may be designated Pinot noir, “clairet” or “Schillerwein”. They most often have a transparent pink to red colour of variable intensity.

3° – Causal interactions

A northern vineyard, protected from oceanic influences by the Vosges massif, it enjoys optimal sunshine. It is mainly this situation that gives the wines a common taste identity.

The diversity of viticultural situations, the variety of soils and subsoils and the very particular mesoclimates have led Alsace producers to retain a very wide palette of mainly aromatic varieties, favouring the maintenance of plant biodiversity and resisting any temptation to simplify the range of varieties. In the Alsace context, this plant diversity is the guarantee of the best expression of the terroir, forged around a strong “Alsace” identity.

The choice of varieties has oriented production essentially towards very aromatic wines. The diversity of viticultural situations, with very varied geo-pedological conditions, has offered Alsace producers the possibility of finding, for each of the varieties that has become established, its conditions of optimal expression. The rigorous and precise delimitation, inspired by the historical cores of production, the complementary, communal and local denominations and the corresponding planting plan give concrete form to this determination to achieve a good match.

The protection of the Vosges massif gives Alsace a dry, very sunny semi-continental climate that allows optimal development of the vine, framed by demanding minimum rules for the sugar content of the grapes. The location on the hillsides and the climate, characterised by the alternation of hot days and cool nights throughout the grape ripening period, combined with a high planting density and foliage height, ensure good ripeness of the grapes (balance of sugars and tartaric acidity), preserve freshness, and develop and concentrate the aromas of the wines and their length on the palate. The average altitude of the vineyard (200 m to 400 m), which corresponds to the optimal thermal belt, makes it possible to ensure a qualitative balance of the natural tartaric acidity. All these conditions thus contribute to forming the characteristics of the wines of Alsace.

The excellent late-season climatic conditions, often favourable to concentration on the vine and to the development of noble rot, allow the production of wines from overripe harvests. Manual harvesting, more demanding minimum sugar content rules and the prohibition of enrichment preserve this

potential. The minimum ageing of eighteen months allows the wines to improve, their great complexity and aromatic power becoming richer over time.

The proximity of the Rhine already constituted in the Middle Ages an important communication route which has always favoured the export of the region's wines to the countries at the mouth of the river and beyond. Dispatches outside the national territory and exports still represent more than a quarter of production today.

Driven by all the wine-growers, who have developed direct sales there, the Alsace Wine Route, which also showcases the historic and still living alliance with Alsace gastronomy, is the most attractive tourist site of the region. It constitutes a major asset of the Alsace economy.

"Highly esteemed white wines" according to André Jullien in 1822, they are "dry with a very pronounced aromatic bouquet". They were formerly transported as far as Mainz, where they were used in blends with Rhine wines to give them strength and enrich their aromatic palette. Jules Guyot in 1866 said of the white wines of Alsace that they "offer much sought-after qualities, ranking very high on the scale of white wines". The white wines from the riesling B variety were moreover his preference, "remarkable for their good taste, their strength and their longevity".

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Delimited parcel area

On a transitional basis, for the complementary geographical denomination "Klevener de Heiligenstein", the parcels planted with savagnin rose Rs excluded from the delimited parcel area, identified by their cadastral reference and their area, the list of which was approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 6 and 7 November 1996, and provided that they meet the conditions set out in the present specification, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the complementary geographical denomination "Klevener de Heiligenstein" until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2021 harvest inclusive.

2° – Grape varieties

The communal planting plan approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality applies only to new plantings, replantings or top-graftings carried out from the date on which the said plan is lodged at the town hall of the commune concerned.

3° – Training methods

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace"

The planting density and the trellising and pruning rules do not apply to vine parcels planted before 25 October 2011. These vine parcels continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the designation "Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2033 harvest inclusive. However, these vines:

- comply with the rules relating to the distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire;

- comply with the rules relating to the maximum number of free eyes per plant;

- when pruned by the Guyot method, must be pruned by single Guyot or double Guyot pruning.

"Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by a complementary geographical denomination

The planting density and the trellising and pruning rules do not apply to vine parcels planted before:

- 25 October 2011 for "Alsace" or "Vin d'Alsace" followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by one of the following complementary geographical denominations: "Blienschwiller"; "Côtes de Barr";

“Côte de Rouffach”; “Klevener de Heiligenstein”; “Ottrott”; “Rodern”; “Saint-Hippolyte”; “Scherwiller”; “Vallée Noble”; “Val Saint Grégoire”; “Wolxheim”;

- 9 September 2014 for “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by one of the following complementary geographical denominations: “Bergheim”; “Coteaux du Haut-Koenigsbourg”.

These vine parcels continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the designation “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” followed by the name of a lieu-dit or followed by a complementary geographical denomination until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2033 harvest inclusive. However, these vines:

- comply with the rules relating to the distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire;

- comply with the rules relating to the maximum number of free eyes per plant;

- when pruned by the Guyot method, must be pruned by single Guyot or double Guyot pruning.

“Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by the terms “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles”

The planting density and the trellising and pruning rules do not apply to vine parcels planted before 20 June 2016. These vine parcels continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the designation “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace”, whether or not followed by a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit, supplemented by one of the terms vendanges tardives or sélection de grains nobles, until they are grubbed up and at the latest until the 2033 harvest inclusive. However, these vines:

- comply with the rules relating to the distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire;

- comply with the rules relating to the maximum number of free eyes per plant;

- when pruned by the Guyot method, must be pruned by single Guyot or double Guyot pruning.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

White wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Alsace” or “Vin d’Alsace” is claimed, with the exception of the terms “Vendanges Tardives” and “Sélection de Grains Nobles”, and which are presented under the said appellation may not be offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless the indication of the sugar content, as defined by European regulations, is entered in very conspicuous characters in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – For wines presented under the customary denomination “Edelzwicker”, the indication of one or more customary denominations may not appear on the containers, labels and commercial documents.

b) – The use of two or more customary denominations on the same label is prohibited.

c) – Wines presented, under the terms of the present specification, under a customary denomination may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless the said denomination is entered in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever.

d) – Wines liable to benefit from the terms “vendanges tardives” and “sélection de grains nobles” must be presented:

- with the indication of the vintage;

- and with one of the following customary denominations: Gewurztraminer, Muscat, Muscat Ottonel, Pinot gris, Riesling.

e) – The varieties of interest for adaptation purposes may not be mentioned on the labelling.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel assignment for vines liable to benefit from a complementary geographical denomination or the name of a lieu-dit

The prior declaration of parcel assignment is lodged with the defence and management body before 1 March of the year of harvest. This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identity of the operator receiving the grapes, where applicable;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the grape variety.

2. Prior declaration of parcel assignment for vines liable to produce red wines

The prior declaration of parcel assignment is lodged with the defence and management body before 1 March of the year of harvest. This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identity of the operator receiving the grapes, where applicable;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area.

3. Prior declaration of parcel assignment for vines liable to benefit from the term “vendanges tardives” or “sélection de grains nobles”

The prior declaration of parcel assignment is lodged with the defence and management body before 1 March of the year of harvest. This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identity of the operator receiving the grapes, where applicable;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area, the grape variety.

4. Irrigation declaration

An irrigation declaration is sent to the defence and management body and to the control body at the latest 2 days before irrigation, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

5. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, before 15 August preceding the harvest, the parcels for which they renounce producing the controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

6. Declaration relating to vinification vat capacity

Every operator vinifying wines of the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body, at the latest on 31 August of the year of harvest, a declaration relating to the capacity of their vinification vats. The cellar plan annexed to the identification declaration may serve as the declaration relating to vinification vat capacity. This declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, unless changes are notified by the operator before 31 August of the year of harvest. In the event of a sale of grapes, this declaration specifies the destination of the harvest, in particular on the basis of the inter-trade contract entered into.

7. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is lodged with the defence and management body at least 15 days before the first exit of products from the vinification cellar and at the latest 60 days after the date of placing on the market for the consumer.

It indicates:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

8. Prior declaration of collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the approved control body a transaction declaration for the lot concerned between the day the transaction is contracted and at least eight days before collection. If the volume actually collected differs by more or less than 10 % from the volume indicated when the contract was concluded, the operator makes a correction available to the approved control body.

9. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of 15 days after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

No particular provisions.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary or field checks
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Ripeness of the grapes: sugar content and minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume (including the check of the specific conditions concerning the traditional terms “Vendanges Tardives” and “Sélection de Grains Nobles”)	Documentary or field checks
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Packaged wines	Analytical and organoleptic examination

II. – References concerning the control structure

Institut National de l’Origine et de la Qualité (INAO)

TSA 30003, 93555 MONTREUIL Cedex

Tel.: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00 – Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.